



Software Engineering

Teaching Assistant (TA) Handbook

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Introduction

Congratulations on your employment with the Software Engineering (SE) Department! This policy document describes the responsibilities and expectations for Teaching Assistants in the SE Department at Rochester Institute of Technology.

In order to work on campus, you will need to have a valid SEO card. If you have previously worked on campus, please visit <https://www.rit.edu/careerservices/students/on-campus-employment> to verify your eligibility to begin working. If you have not worked on campus before, you must complete the hiring process with the SEO office. This includes completing the I-9 form and in order to be eligible, you must be enrolled in classes full-time (12 credits for Undergrads).

It is important to note that the Teaching Assistant's objective is to support the faculty in providing a quality education to the students. You should read and familiarize yourself with this document, as your signature on this handbook is part of your contract with SE. Your position as a Teaching Assistant (TA) in our school is an important and valuable role. Many of our courses can only operate because of your efforts.

Your course instructor will be your main point of contact, *unless* it is anything in regards to your timecard (corrections, missed punches, etc). If you have any issues contacting the instructor, please contact the SE office directly by emailing softwareengineering@rit.edu. Please note: this opportunity is at the discretion of the instructor, and repeated violations or violations of an extreme nature may *not* be given a second chance.

Whether you are a new or returning TA, it is very important to have a conversation with your instructor at the beginning of the semester about their expectations, as you may not be the only TA assigned to that course. It is crucial to ensure that all members of your instructional team are on the same page.

General Expectations and Responsibilities

Be Respectful -

- Respect the students, the instructor(s), your fellow TA's and staff. This includes language, both verbal and written; body language; common courtesies; modes of address; and other forms of respect.
- If you have a disagreement with faculty, please contact the SE office immediately. If you have a disagreement with a student, please contact your faculty member immediately. If the instructor is not available, then contact the SE office instead.
- If you have a disagreement in regards to the course (assignment or material), discuss it with the faculty member **before** bringing it to the attention of the students.

Be on time -

- To classes, labs, office hours, meetings, and appointments. If you do not understand the instructions or requests from the instructor, be sure to communicate this clearly and promptly.

Be Professional -

- Make sure to check your RIT email and any other routine course communications (MyCourses) regularly. Be mindful that this position is a job and should be treated as such. Maintain separation between professional and private interactions. If you become overwhelmed at any point throughout the semester, be proactive and discuss with your instructor as to avoid burnout.

Grading Reminders -

- The key to grading is to be consistent and documented. You'll be making decisions as you grade and when you do, document your decision. That way, if the instructor wants to grade things differently, you can go back to adjust.
- You are responsible for understanding the work that you grade. If you do not understand the assignment, it is very difficult to assign fair grades.
- Seek assistance from your instructor if need be. It is particularly important to pay close attention to any rubrics or guidelines provided by your instructor to ensure that grading is consistent. If you are working with other TA students, be sure everyone is on the same page as far as grading and point deductions. If you notice an error in your grading, you are responsible for ensuring that it is corrected accordingly.
- You don't have to have all of the answers, you need to help them find the answer. If you can't answer a technical question, then tell them what you'd do next if you were in their shoes. Sometimes all they need is the affirmation that they are on the right track.

Some responsibilities of TA's may include, but are not limited to:

- Assisting the faculty in the classroom or in their office
- Meeting with students during office hours/tutoring hours
- Conferencing with students individually or in small groups
- Leading group projects or discussions
- Grading assignments or proctoring exams
- Managing course communications in MyCourses
- Preparing or testing lab materials
- Recording homework assignments and grades
- Providing feedback to students
- Taking attendance or monitoring participation
- Distributing course materials

TA's *CAN NOT* do the following:

- Run classes without faculty supervision
- Proctor midterms or final exams
- Give students direct answers on graded assignments

TA Academic Integrity

Two primary responsibilities:

Integrity of your own actions -

- You must treat all students fairly and equally and offer the same assistance to any student who comes to you for help. If you are in doubt as to whether a student is allowed, check with your instructor.
- You may not give out any answers to graded assignments, labs, or exams. You can lead students toward answers on assignments and labs (but not exams that you may be proctoring) if they are struggling.

Monitoring the students' activities for integrity concerns -

- You should not encourage students to seek help from sources that are not allowed by the course policy. If you are in doubt as to whether a source is allowed, check with your instructor.
- If you notice a student who has violated the course academic integrity policies, it is your duty to report this to the instructor, who will deal with it accordingly. If/when you discover an academic integrity (AI) violation, you should note the date and time, what students were involved, and the nature of the violation after reporting to your faculty instructor.

Timecard and Workday Instructions:

All students are hourly (non-exempt) employees and are paid bi-weekly. You must use your University ID (UID) number to clock in and out using the Workday kiosks located throughout the college.

Payroll is processed every other week on Friday. Pay cycles go from the Friday of that current week to Thursday of the following week. **The time clock must be used for punching in and out during your shift when you are physically working on campus.** Corrections should NEVER be used to overwrite a lateness for your shift. Please note the following rules:

1. You must punch in and out using the Workday Time Clocks, which are located around campus. In Golisano (Bldg. 70), time clocks are located on the first and third floors. Keep in mind that you are able to utilize any of the time clocks in any of the buildings across campus.
2. You cannot work for two jobs on campus simultaneously. Please make sure you have clocked out for one job, before clocking in for another.
3. You may not punch in for your shift and then leave to take care of other things (get lunch, etc). Once you are clocked in, you should begin working.
4. "Fudging" or "incorrect submission" of time worked is fraud and you are subject to termination. You need to record your hours in real-time.
5. You are required to take a 30 minute break if your shift exceeds 6 hours. You MUST punch in and out when taking your mandatory break, and be sure to record your break times if you are working remotely. **Failure to do so is a violation of NYS labor laws, and frequent violations of this may result in termination.** You may check your Workday account [here](#) for missing or incorrect punches. Students are NOT permitted to work during the C-shift (11:59pm - 6:59am), and you must be sure to stay at or under your allowed number of hours/week. You will be notified (via email) for any time card discrepancies. Be sure to check with the SE dept. during academic breaks as these rules may change.

Workday Instructions - How to clock in and out in Workday:

- Wording has changed in Workday, from Kronos. **What used to be called clocking in/punching in is now Check-in. Clocking out/punching out is now called Check-out.**
- Students NO LONGER need to send in an Excel timecard if you work remotely. If you are on campus, you must be utilizing the physical time-clocks located around campus. If you need to have a punch corrected or you have missed a punch in/out, you must email the details to SE Office Manager: Marie Barreto (msbfaa@rit.edu). Corrections are due to Marie by Friday of that week, by 10:00 am at the latest. Please be as specific as possible when sending in corrections (the day, the date, and indication of AM or PM) .

If corrections are received after that time, it will be considered late, and we will not be able to guarantee that your hours will be entered for that pay period. You will still be paid for all hours worked, but you will see those hours reflected in the following pay period instead.

Payroll/Direct Deposit Information

Student Employees are paid bi-weekly on Fridays, and you will receive a regular paycheck for all hours you have worked. Wages do not get applied directly to a student's tuition. Student employees are strongly encouraged to register for Direct Deposit through <https://myinfo.rit.edu/>. Students taking advantage of the direct deposit option can view their pay stubs online.

Please note: First paychecks and the paychecks of student employees who choose not to sign up for direct deposit will be sent to the address entered on the employee's I-9 form which is mandated by the federal government.

Students who have completed the employment eligibility process and have worked for an on-campus employer for 3 weeks or more without receiving a paycheck should check with the SE dept. as soon as the first expected paycheck is not received. Often the problem can be rectified immediately and arrangements can be made for the student to receive partial payment of wages owed. If the department cannot assist the student with the problem, then the student is advised to contact the Student Employment Office (SEO).

Each 14-day pay period runs from Friday through the following Thursday. The pay date is Friday of the following week. Employees should refer to the campus payroll schedule (<https://www.rit.edu/controller/payroll-schedules>) for appropriate pay dates and payroll ending dates. Paychecks for employees who are not on direct deposit get mailed to their homes prior to the pay date.

This TA handbook is a supplement to the RIT Student Employee Handbook. This is an outline which acts as guidelines to provide an overview of the policies and practices specific to the SE dept. It is not meant to replace information from the Student Employment Office (SEO). Please refer to the SEO website

<https://www.rit.edu/careerservices/students/on-campus-employment> for additional information about student employment.

I, Piter Garcia, acknowledge that I have received, read and understand the SE Teaching Assistant Handbook.



02/06/2026

(sign and date)